business class now began to lend financial and personal support to the Congress party and especially to Gandhi. It also seemed like sound business sense to cultivate relationships with the people who would in future form the government of India.

Nonetheless, many of these titans of industry appear to have been genuinely motivated by a desire to help India prosper, both economically and socially.

Many engaged in philanthropic activities, often in major ways. For instance, they donated large sums of money to causes they believed in, from women's education to famine relief. They also helped set up pioneering educational and research institutions. Some even took to local politics to improve sanitation and urban conditions. This section features some of the many Indian industrialists who, in different ways, helped make modern India.

GHANSHYAM DAS BIRLA

1894–1983